



*In the beginning there was nothing: no sky, sand or sea, no life, earth or grass. There was only Ginnungagap, a Great Void of dark and uninterrupted silence.*

North of Ginnungagap lay Niflheim, a world of ice and swirling mists. To the south was Muspelheim, the land of fire. In Ginnungagap, the ice melted into a surging liquid and a life was born – a gigantic being of creation and chaos, called Ymir. More beings, both male and female, emerged from Ymir's legs and armpits, and these became a new race – the Frost Giants.

*As more ice melted, it formed a huge cow called Audhumla and Ymir grew strong on her milk.*

Soon Audhumla became thirsty and licked the salty ice blocks that lay all around. As her rough tongue scraped at the ice, a shape began to form: at first the hair, then the head, and finally the entire body of a god – limbs and all. His name was Buri, and when he emerged from the ice he flexed his muscles and felt power pulse through him.

Buri had a son called Bor, who in time married a giantess, Bestla. Together they had three sons: Odin, Vili and Ve, who were destined to destroy and create. These young and vigorous gods explored mist-shrouded Niflheim and flame-belching Muspelheim – and decided it was not nearly enough for them.